CONVENERS

Dr. Sanjeeva Nayaka, Scientist-G, CSIR-NBRI, Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh.
Dr. Anushree Baruah, Assistant Professor, The Assam Royal University, Guwahati, Assam.

ORGANIZING SECRETARIES

Dr. Sthiti Porna Dutta, Associate Professor, The Assam Royal University, Guwahati, Assam.
Dr. Gaurav K. Mishra, Scientist-D, CSIR-NBRI, Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh.
Dr. Siljo Joseph, Scientist, KSCSTE - Kerala Forest Research Institute, Peechi, Thrissur, Keralam.

TREASURERS

Dr Upashna Chettri, Assistant Professor, The Assam Royal University, Guwahati, Assam.
Dr. Vinay Sahu, Senior Technical Officer, CSIR-NBRI, Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh.

CONGRESS OBJECTIVES

- Explore cryptogamic diversity, taxonomy, ecology, and evolution.
- Address conservation challenges arising from climate change and environmental threats.
- Highlight the biotechnological, pharmaceutical, agricultural, and ecological potential of cryptogams.
- Foster interdisciplinary collaboration, knowledge exchange, and capacity building for sustainable utilization.

TECHNICAL SESSIONS

The conference invites abstracts related to cryptogamic (Algae, Lichens, Fungi, Bryophytes, and Pteridophytes) research under the following themes:

- Taxonomy, Systematics, Floristics, Biodiversity and Conservation
- Biology, Evolution and Ecological Interactions
- Biotechnology, Bioinformatics and Omics for Health
- Natural Products, Bioprospecting and Sustainable Utilization
- Climate Change, Environmental Monitoring and Ecosystem Restoration
- Applied Cryptogam Research for Sustainable Development

REGISTRATION DETAILS

Category of Participants	Before 15 Oct 2026 (without accommodation)	After 15 Oct 2026 (without accommodation)
Delegates (ILS life members)	Rs. 4000/-	Rs. 5000/-
Delegates (non-ILS members)	Rs. 5000/-	Rs. 6000/-
Research Scholars/ P.G. Students (ILS Life members)	Rs. 2000/-	Rs. 3000/-
Research Scholars/P.G. Students (non-ILS members)	Rs. 2500/-	Rs. 3500/-
Accompanying Person#	Rs. 2500/-	Rs. 3500/-

FEE REMITTANCE DETAILS & IMPORTANT DATES

Registration fee in cash will be accepted from local participants during spot registration on the inaugural day of the conference, with late fee.

Important Dates to Remember

Abstract Submission (open): September 1, 2026
Abstract Submission (close): Extended to October 30, 2026

The registration fee should be paid through RTGS/NEFT/IMPS and UPI in favour of "Indian Lichenological Society".

AccountNo.:34349534762
Name:IndianLichenologicalSociety
Bank:StateBankofIndia
IFSCCode:SBIN0010173 MICR Code: 226002051
Branch: NBRI Lucknow
Address: National Botanical Research Institute,Rana Pratap Marg, Lucknow

Registration fee includes conference kit, and food (breakfast, lunch, and dinner). Delegates include Scientists, Professors, JRFs, SRFs, project fellows, Post-doctoral Fellows, and Industry professionals.
#Accompanying persons will not receive a conference kit; they will only be provided with food during the conference.

CONTACT DETAILS

Dr. Gaurav K. Mishra
Secretary, Indian Lichenological society, Scientist-D, CSIR-NBRI, Lucknow Contact: +91 9415688614 |Email: gmishrak@gmail.com
Dr. Anushree Baruah
Assistant Professor, Dept. of Botany, RGU, Guwahati
Contact: +91 9864072177 | Email: abaruah@rgu.ac

Scan this QR to register

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THE ASSAM ROYAL GLOBAL UNIVERSITY
GUWAHATI

National Conference on

Cryptogamic Diversity, Conservation and Sustainable Utilization

November 26–27, 2026

Jointly Organized by

Department of Botany,
The Assam Royal
Global University, Guwahati, Assam

Indian Lichenological Society,
Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh

CSIR–National Botanical Research Institute,
Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh

PREAMBLE

Cryptogams, encompassing algae, fungi, lichens, bryophytes, and pteridophytes, represent an important component of Earth's biodiversity. They perform indispensable ecosystem functions, contributing to primary productivity, soil formation and stabilization, nutrient cycling, decomposition of organic matter, carbon sequestration, nitrogen fixation, water retention, and habitat formation for numerous microorganisms and invertebrates. Owing to their remarkable sensitivity to environmental changes, many cryptogams serve as reliable bioindicators of air quality, climate change, and ecosystem health. Furthermore, these organisms have emerged as valuable resources for biotechnology, pharmaceuticals, agriculture, environmental remediation, and other sustainable applications.

Although these non-seed-bearing organisms have received less attention than flowering plants, research on cryptogams has expanded considerably over the past few decades. In India, systematic studies have significantly advanced our understanding of their taxonomy, diversity, ecology, phylogeny, conservation, and potential applications. Comprehensive floras, monographs, checklists, and molecular investigations have established a strong foundation for future research. However, rapid urbanization, habitat degradation, pollution, invasive species, and climate change pose serious threats to their diversity and survival, creating an urgent need to strengthen research, documentation, conservation, capacity building, and sustainable utilization through interdisciplinary approaches.

Recognizing these priorities, this conference brings together scientists, academicians, researchers, students, policymakers, and industry professionals working on algae, fungi, lichens, bryophytes, and pteridophytes — a platform for exchanging knowledge, showcasing advances, and discussing strategies for conservation and sustainable utilization of cryptogamic resources.

ABOUT THE SOCIETY — ILS

The Indian Lichenological Society (ILS) is a professional scientific society established in 2014 to promote research, education, and awareness in lichenology and related cryptogamic sciences. The Society is registered under the Societies Registration Act, 1860, at Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh, India.

ILS serves as a national and international platform for scientists, academicians, researchers, students, and enthusiasts working in lichenology and other cryptogam groups, advancing fundamental and applied research in taxonomy, systematics, biodiversity, ecology, conservation, molecular biology, biomonitoring, biotechnology, and sustainable utilization. ILS publishes its peer-reviewed journal, Cryptogam Biodiversity and Assessment (CBA), and the ILS e-letter, and regularly organizes national and international conferences, symposia, workshops, training programmes, field excursions, and outreach activities. The Society offers membership to any interested cryptogam researcher.

ABOUT THE ASSAM ROYAL GLOBAL UNIVERSITY

The Assam Royal Global University (RGU), Guwahati, is one of the leading private universities in North-East India, built on a distinguished legacy of over 23 years of excellence in higher education. Spread across a vibrant 30-acre campus with more than 1.8 million square feet of world-class infrastructure, the University offers 130+ academic programmes through 26 schools. RGU is supported by 500+ faculty members and 140+ state-of-the-art laboratories.

RGU is the only private university from North-East India ranked among the Top 30 institutions in Physical Sciences and Top 100 in Academics in the Nature Index Institutional Rankings, and the only one in the region with three faculty members among the World's Top 2% Scientists (Stanford–Elsevier World Rankings 2025).

ABOUT CSIR–NATIONAL BOTANICAL RESEARCH INSTITUTE

CSIR–National Botanical Research Institute (CSIR–NBRI), Lucknow, is a premier plant science research institute under the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR), New Delhi. Originally established as the National Botanical Gardens (NBG) by the Government of Uttar Pradesh, it became a constituent laboratory of CSIR in 1953.
CSIR–NBRI has made significant contributions to the study of cryptogams — algae, fungi, lichens, bryophytes, and pteridophytes — integrating classical taxonomy with molecular phylogenetics, genomics, metabolomics, and biotechnology. The institute houses the internationally recognized LWG Herbarium, one of India's largest cryptogamic collections with 1.5+ lakh specimens, alongside advanced analytical and molecular biology laboratories.

CALL FOR ABSTRACT

Original research abstracts are invited for oral and poster presentations on all thematic areas of the conference. Abstracts should be written in English and must not exceed **300 words** (excluding title, authors' names, affiliations, and keywords), and submitted only through the designated Google Form. A confirmation email will follow successful submission; if none arrives within 10 days, contact indianlichenology@gmail.com.

The Scientific Programme Committee will review all submissions and reserves the right to accept, edit, assign the presentation mode (oral/poster), or reject any abstract. Accepted abstracts are included in the abstract book only after the presenting author completes registration and payment.

Each registered presenting author may submit a maximum of two abstracts, with complete affiliation details, institutional address, email, mobile number, and the relevant conference theme. Keywords (5–6) must be included; figures and references should not. The last date for abstract submission is 15 October 2026; late submissions may not be considered.

AWARDS AND RECOGNITIONS

To recognize and encourage excellence in cryptogam research, the following
awards will be presented at the conference:

Dr. D.D. Awasthi Memorial Lifetime Achievement Award

Honors a senior lichenologist for exceptional contributions to lichenology in India; recipient selected by the ILS Executive Council, receiving a memento and citation.

Dr. P.G. Patwardhan Award

Given for the best oral presentation in both the student and delegate categories.

Dr. Ajay Singh Award

Recognizes the best poster presentations in both the student and delegate categories.

Dr. D.K. Upreti Best Thesis Award

Recognizes the best thesis in lichenology submitted each academic year by candidates under 35 years of age. Eligible members are requested to submit a soft copy of their application in the prescribed proforma. You can download the file from www.indianlichenology.com

Fellowship for the Indian Lichenological Society (ILS)

Life Members who have maintained continuous membership with the Society for a minimum period of five years are eligible to apply for fellowship. Eligible members are requested to submit a soft copy of their application in the prescribed proforma. You can download the file from www.indianlichenology.com

HOW TO REACH THE VENUE?

The Assam Royal Global University is strategically located in Guwahati, the eastern part of India, also known as the Gateway of Southeast Asia. With a renewed emphasis on the Act East policy, the region has become a hotbed of developmental activity and an educational destination for many, easily accessible to the neighbouring countries of Bhutan, Bangladesh, Myanmar, and Nepal. Guwahati is well connected by both air and rail with the rest of the Indian subcontinent. The University is located in Guwahati, Betkuchi, next to National Highway 37 — only 22 km from LGBI Airport, 12 km from both the Guwahati and Kamakhya railway stations, and just 500 m from the Inter-State Bus Terminus (ISBT).

CHIEF PATRON	**Dr. A. K. Pansari,** Chancellor, The Assam Royal Global University, Guwahati, Assam.
PATRONS	**Prof. A. K. Buragohain,** Vice-Chancellor, The Assam Royal University, Guwahati, Assam.
	Dr. Zabeer Ahmed, Director, CSIR-NBRI, Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh.
	Dr. D.K. Upreti, Emeritus Scientist, CSIR-NBRI, Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh.